

Don Wettrick is a high school teacher who is also the co-founder and CEO of StartEdUp Innovation program. He spoke about his program on the *ChooseFI* podcast. Wettrick challenges the conventional wisdom that everyone should go to college. He said, “You want to go to medical school? You got to go to college. You want to go into advanced engineering? Got to go to college.” But what does he advise others, whose careers don’t absolutely require a degree? What if someone is considering a journalism degree? Wettrick said, “Start a freaking blog!”

College proponents argue there is more value to college than a degree, such as developing a network. Wettrick said, “You know who has an advantage? When you’re [graduating college at] 22, you’re everybody else.” He points out that a sixteen-year-old who is genuinely interested and driven can start learning, creating, and gaining experience at a young age while everyone else is worried about grades and looking good on a college application. This can give that young person tremendous advantages.

Wettrick also points out that he’s putting his money where his mouth is. He’s letting his daughter, a high school senior, choose her own path in life. He said, “She’s got a 3.9 [GPA], and at a minimum,